

Structure: Adverbial clause

An adverbial clause tells us more about the action of the verb in the main clause. It tells us when, how, where, to what extent, under what condition the action in the main clause takes place.

Types of Adverbial clause

The type of adverbial information supplied on the verb is the basis for naming adverbial clauses.

- A. Adverbial clause of time: This tells us when the action of the main verb takes place. It is usually introduced by while, when, whenever, before, until, after, since as soon as. Examples
While watching the television news I saw the boy being interviewed
Before you start answering the questions, read the instructions
- B. Adverbial Clause of reason: This state why the action of the main clause takes place. It is usually introduced by as, since, because. Examples
He succeeded in the interview because he prepared for it.
We left his office since he was not ready to pay us.
- C. Adverbial clause of purpose: It shows the motive behind the action of the main clause. It is usually introduced by so that, in order that. Examples
I gave him the money so that he could buy the goods in order that peace will reign he was released.
- D. Adverbial clause of concession: Clauses of concession indicates that what happens in main clause is contrary to what one expects in the light of the information in the subordinate clause. They are introduced by although, though, if, even if, even though, when, whereas, while, despite, inspite of, irrespective of, regardless of, notwithstanding. Examples
Although he is poor, he is very intelligent.
She is very pretty even if she is dark in complexion
- E. Adverbial clause of place: It tells us where the action of the main verb takes place. It is often introduced by wherever, where, anywhere, etc. Examples
Anywhere you go, I will follow you
Children can play wherever they like
- F. Adverbial clause of manner. It tells us how the action of the main verb is performed. It is introduced by as, though, as if Examples.
She was crying as if somebody died
The man was talking as if he owns the whole world.
- G. Adverbial clause of result: It shows the outcome of the action of the man verb. It is usually introduced by so, therefore, so that, as a result, hence. Examples
I worked so hard, that I had a breakdown
I took the umbrella so that rain will not beat me

H. Adverbial clause of condition: This states the condition necessary for the action of the main verb to take place. It is usually introduced by; on condition that, if, unless, while, provided, as long as. Examples

I will go for the party if they invite me

I will not leave you, unless you bless me.